

A link is established

Among the galaxy of eminent persons present at Jubbulpore on 8 March, 1870 was Alfred, the Duke of Edinburgh, who was on a visit to India. Lord Mayo, the Viceroy and Governor-General of India (1869–72), travelled by train from Bombay with the Governor of Bombay, Sir Seymour Fitzgerald. Other dignitaries present included the Commander-in-Chief of India, the British Resident at Hyderabad, and the Indian kings of Rewa, Holkar, Panna, and Maihar, among others.

Immediately upon reaching the station, there was a general rush to reach the point where the GIPR and EIR lines met. The Viceroy received a silver-plated hammer, which he used to strike the silver key that connected the two rails. He then handed over the hammer to the Duke of Edinburgh, who also gave the key a tap and the link between Bombay and Calcutta was officially opened.